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4. 4 Pigeon - *Columba livia*

Birds belong to the Class Aves (L. *avis* - birds). The most distinguishing feature of birds is the possession of feathers. The study of birds is **Ornithology**. A bird is a **feathered, bipedal, flying vertebrate** possessing **wings.** Their external and internal organization correlates with its aerial habit. More than 500 species of pigeon exist throughout the world. In India, about 10 species of pigeons are found. ***Columba livia*** is found throughout India (Figure 4.26).

Classification

Phylum	:	Chordata
Class	:	Aves
Order	:	Columbiformes
Genus	:	Columba
Species	:	*livia*

External features

The compact, boat shaped streamlined body of pigeon is well adapted for their aerial mode of life. The body of pigeon is

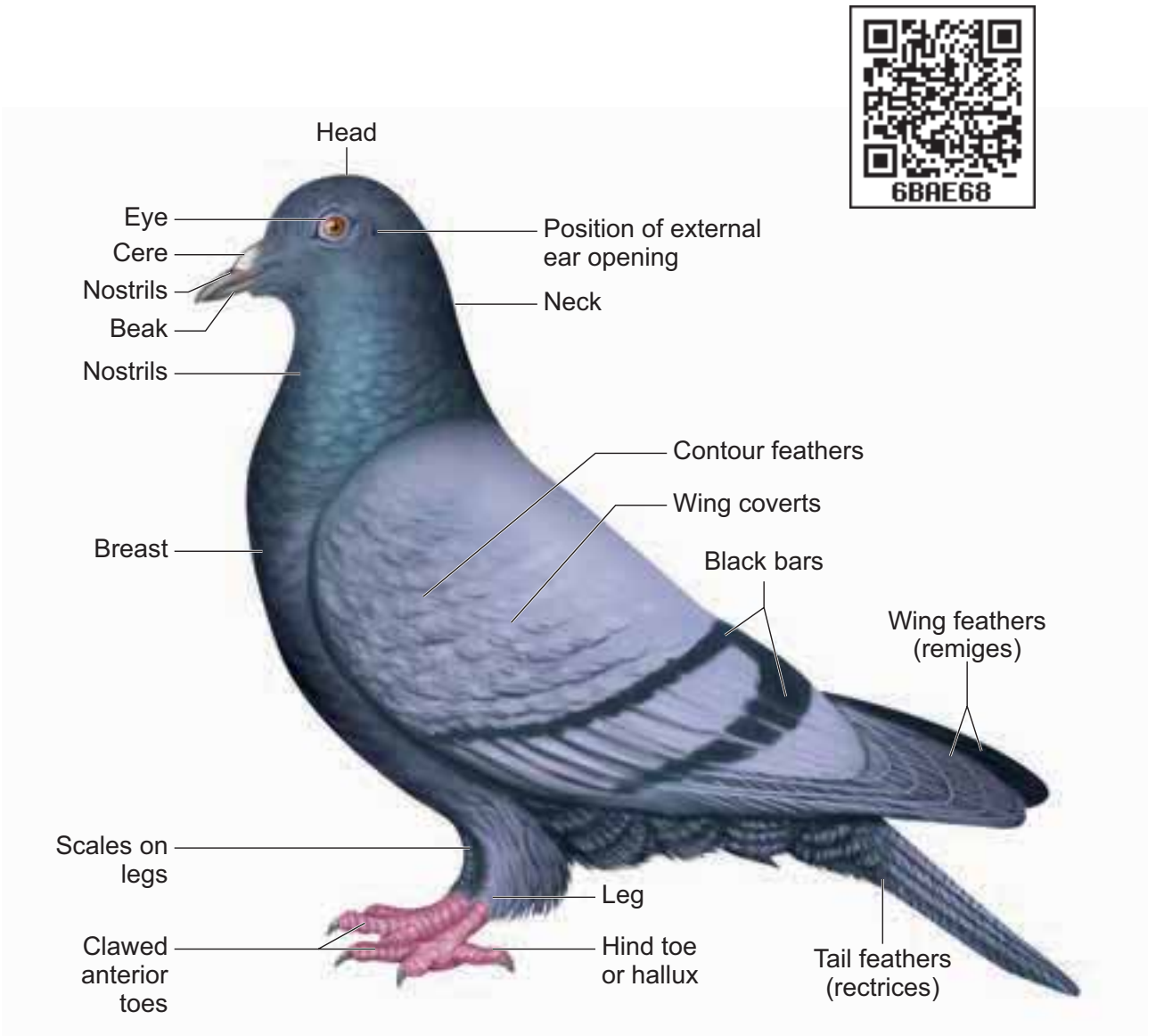


Figure 4.26 Columba livia – Common Rock Pigeon-External Features